

AUROKRISHNAA RAVINDRAN LAKSHMI

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Dual Master's graduate (MS Finance – Quantitative Mathematics, MBA - Finance) and **FRM Level I candidate** with 5+ years of experience in investment operations, fund accounting, FP&A, and financial reporting. Proven track record of building global investment classification systems, automating reconciliation workflows (60%+ faster processing), delivering variance analyses that drove \$2M+ in budget decisions, and developing Python & Power BI tools adopted across cross-functional teams. **Open to Relocation.**

CORE COMPETENCIES

Technical: Advanced Excel (Power Query, Power Pivot, VBA), Power BI (DAX, Data Modeling), Tableau, SQL, Python (Pandas, NumPy, Automation), R, Bloomberg Terminal, LSEG Yield Book, SAP / Oracle / NetSuite, QuickBooks, Alteryx, Agile / SDLC, SAS

Finance: Budgeting & Forecasting, Variance Analysis, FP&A, KPI & Management Reporting, Financial Statement Analysis, NAV Computation & Validation, Fund Accounting, Account Reconciliations, AP/AR Management, Cash Flow Planning, Internal Controls & Audit Support

AI & Automation: Prompt Engineering, LLM-Assisted Research & Reporting, AI Workflow Automation, Structured Data Extraction, Document Analysis (ChatGPT, Claude, Gemini, Copilot, Hugging Face, Ollama), RAG Pipelines, OCR, API Integration

Professional: Stakeholder Management, Executive Communication, Cross-Functional Collaboration, Process Improvement, Team Leadership, Attention to Detail, Project Management, Strategic Planning, Risk Assessment, Data-Driven Decision Making

EDUCATION

M.S. in Finance (Quantitative Mathematics) – University at Buffalo, SUNY GPA: 3.8	Jan 2024 – Jun 2025
M.B.A. (Finance) – Anna University GPA: 3.7	2020 – 2022
B.Com in Accounting & Finance – University of Madras GPA: 3.8	2017 – 2020

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Investments & Research Analyst

Sep 2025 – Present

Photis Wealth AI

New York, NY

- Architected the firm's global investment taxonomy from the ground up: conducted primary research across 10+ countries & multiple currencies, defined classification logic spanning 500+ instruments, 50+ asset wrappers, 10+ asset classes, and 50+ risk factors, and standardized naming conventions, establishing the foundational data framework for all downstream classification, controls, and reporting.
- Mapped taxonomy to live global instruments across equities, fixed income, alternatives, and multi-asset wrappers; built a production SQL reference database that standardized due diligence, reduced misclassification errors by 35% across 4 teams, and cut instrument onboarding time by 25%.
- Conducted investment research via Morningstar, SEC filings, and fund disclosures across U.S., European, and Asia-Pacific markets; validated 1,200+ data inputs monthly, flagged 50+ pricing/NAV exceptions per cycle, and documented root-cause drivers for investment committee review.
- Built an end-to-end Python pipeline integrating 4 APIs with a SQLite rules engine, automating daily holdings reconciliation across multi-currency portfolios and cutting manual review from 8 hours to under 3 hours per cycle (~63% reduction) with full audit traceability.
- Developed a rule-based scoring model aligning client risk profiles to 200+ products across global markets with 92% back-tested accuracy; delivered Python analytical dashboards and Power BI executive dashboards tracking allocation drift, concentration risk, and performance attribution for \$150M+ in advisory AUM.

Financial Analyst

Aug 2025 – Present

Community Dreams Foundation

Buffalo, NY

- Deliver monthly budget tracking, bank reconciliations, and variance analysis across 8 program budgets totaling \$2.1M spanning clean energy access, community technology solutions, workforce development, and sustainable growth initiatives for underserved communities; identified \$150K in savings, 100% adopted by leadership.
- Serve as subject matter expert on U.S. nonprofit accounting, NPO compliance, and GAAP standards; advise program leads on grant cost allocation, restricted vs. unrestricted fund treatment, and audit-ready documentation across 5 active federal and foundation grants.
- Led 3 cross-functional financial projects: an FX risk dashboard monitoring \$400K in international disbursements, a mutual fund performance tracker for the organization's endowment portfolio, and a household financial wellbeing assessment tool supporting community outreach programs.
- Built Excel and Python templates automating 70% of data validation, cutting month-end close from 7 to 5 days; created a grant expenditure tracker with compliance flags that reduced audit prep by 40% and achieved zero findings across 2 external audits.
- Developed a community impact analytics dashboard consolidating program KPIs (households served, energy cost savings, job placement rates, training completions), enabling quarterly outcome reporting to funders and the board.

Graduate Teaching Assistant – Financial Derivatives

Jan 2025 – Jun 2025

University at Buffalo, SUNY

Buffalo, NY

- Supported 150+ graduate students in a rigorous derivatives course; designed and led 20+ review sessions on Black-Scholes-Merton pricing, Greeks, delta/gamma hedging, and risk-neutral valuation, translating complex quantitative concepts into structured, exam-ready frameworks.
- Created comprehensive solution guides, grading rubrics, and 50+ original practice problems that improved average exam scores by 12%; received a 4.8/5.0 student satisfaction rating for clarity, responsiveness, and instructional quality.
- Held weekly office hours averaging 15+ consultations per week; developed targeted supplemental materials addressing misconceptions in implied volatility, option sensitivities, and hedging mechanics, reducing repeat questions by 30% and contributing to a 100% course pass rate.

Finance Manager – Investments & Operations

Aurochild International School

Jan 2022 – Dec 2023

Cuddalore, India

- Directed budgeting, cash flow planning, and monthly close for a \$3.5M operating budget across 8 cost centers (academics, facilities, transport, dining, athletics, administration, student services, capital projects); delivered variance reports and rolling 12-month forecasts guiding \$500K+ in reallocation decisions.
- Managed full-cycle AP/AR: tuition collections (\$1.2M across 600+ families), vendor payments for 40+ suppliers, daily bank/cash reconciliations, payroll for 85+ staff, and benefits administration, maintaining 99.5% reconciliation accuracy and reducing payroll errors by 25%.
- Supervised a 4-person accounting team; established SOPs for journal entries, accruals, and close checklists that reduced month-end close from 12 to 7 days and enabled real-time budget-vs-actual dashboards for department heads.
- Redesigned fee collection with automated trackers, SMS/email reminders, and escalation triggers, improving on-time payment from 72% to 91% and recovering \$85K in overdue receivables; reduced DSO from 45 to 28 days.
- Monitored reserve fund and endowment liquidity (\$800K+ AUM); prepared quarterly investment summaries, tracked risk exposures, and supported the board on compliance, contract renewals, and \$200K+ in capital expenditure approvals.
- Led procurement negotiations with 15+ vendors, securing \$60K in annual cost savings on facility maintenance, IT equipment, and transportation contracts through competitive bidding and volume discount agreements.
- Coordinated annual external audits: prepared schedules, reconciliations, and supporting documentation for Indian GAAP and Trust Act compliance, achieving clean opinions for both fiscal years with zero material findings.

Human Resources Associate

The Residency Towers

Apr 2021 – Jan 2022

Coimbatore, India

- Administered onboarding, payroll, and benefits coordination for 120+ hospitality employees across 3 departments, reducing payroll discrepancies by 30% through Excel-based reconciliation and audit checks.
- Produced monthly HR analytics dashboards (headcount, attrition, overtime, cost-per-hire), enabling management to optimize staffing and reduce overtime costs by 15% (\$18K annual savings).

Articled Assistant (Chartered Accountancy)

Institute of Chartered Accountants of India

Jan 2018 – Oct 2020

Chennai, India

- Performed ledger scrutiny, reconciliations, and audit working papers for 15+ client engagements across manufacturing, services, and nonprofits with combined revenues exceeding \$6M+.
- Executed statutory and internal audits (vouching, substantive testing, controls documentation), ensuring Indian GAAP, GASB, and Companies Act compliance with zero material findings across 10+ cycles.
- Filed GST, TDS, and income tax returns for 20+ clients (\$1.8M+ assessable value); resolved 30+ tax notices within SLA, maintaining a 98% on-time filing record.

KEY PROJECTS

Multi-Asset Portfolio Optimization & Monte Carlo Simulation | UB Endowment Study | Python, Excel

- Simulated 10,000 return paths (10-year horizon, 7 asset classes) using geometric Brownian motion with regime-switching volatility; applied mean-variance optimization with CRRA utility scoring to identify portfolios improving projected Sharpe ratio by 0.18 and reducing CVaR (95%) by 8%.
- Built an interactive Excel dashboard with scenario toggles (base, bull, bear, stagflation) to visualize drawdown paths, terminal wealth distributions, and spending-policy probability for a \$50M model endowment.

Mutual Fund NAV Validation & Reconciliation Automation | UB Fund Accounting Lab | Excel (Power Query), Python

- Automated daily NAV component validation (pricing, shares, cash, accruals) for 15 simulated fund portfolios with 25+ exception rules catching 95% of discrepancies before T+1 reporting deadlines.
- Reduced manual reconciliation by 75% (4 hours to under 1 hour per cycle); produced a standardized daily variance report with drill-down capability consumed by 3 portfolio teams.

Fund Holdings Classification & Data Quality Pipeline | Photis Wealth AI | Python, SQLite, Excel

- Built a rule-based classification engine processing 2,000+ securities across 8 asset classes with automated reconciliation checks, exception flags, and an auditable change log with timestamps and user IDs.
- Improved classification accuracy from 88% to 97%, reduced downstream data quality escalations by 40%, and created documentation adopted as the team's standard operating procedure.

Annual Budget Forecasting & Fee Collection Optimization | Aurochild International School | Excel (VBA), Power BI

- Designed a VBA-automated budget model consolidating 8 department inputs with trend analysis and enrollment projections, generating rolling 12-month forecasts with $\pm 3\%$ accuracy against actuals.
- Built a Power BI fee dashboard integrating 600+ family payment records with aging analysis, delinquency alerts, and cash flow projections, enabling recovery of \$85K in overdue receivables and reducing DSO from 45 to 28 days.

CERTIFICATIONS

FRM Level I Candidate – GARP | Bloomberg (BMC, BFF, BQL) | Python for Finance – IBM | Google Data Analytics Professional Certificate – SQL | Power BI & DAX Essentials – CFI | Microsoft Excel Expert | FP&A Modeling - Wall Street Prep | Corporate Finance Fundamentals - CFI